Autocomplete Poetry Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and Technology • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and Technology	**Time**	20-30 min
Difficulty	Medium	**ID**	autocomplete-poetry

Big idea: Prediction can imitate creativity.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students explore the difference between prediction, creativity and understanding.

Student Prompt

Inspect Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Students write a poem using only suggested next words from a shared prompt. Rank, sort, or audit this output. Identify which rule, ranking signal, or interface choice shaped your judgement.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Two poems compared: one written by intention, one guided by autocomplete. Rank, sort, or audit this output. Identify which rule, ranking signal, or interface choice shaped your judgement.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Autocomplete Poetry Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A reflection on whether fluency signals authorship or knowledge. Rank, sort, or audit this output. Identify which rule, ranking signal, or interface choice shaped your judgement.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Prediction can imitate creativity.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Does pattern prediction count as understanding?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and Technology.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how prediction can imitate creativity.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Does pattern prediction count as understanding?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: Students write a poem using only suggested next words from a shared prompt.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Students write a poem using only suggested next words from a shared prompt.
- Two poems compared: one written by intention, one guided by autocomplete.
- A reflection on whether fluency signals authorship or knowledge.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: resources/autocomplete-poetry/index.html
- Card deck CSV: resources/autocomplete-poetry/cards.csv
- Visual prompt: resources/autocomplete-poetry/visual-prompt.svg
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Students write the first line of a poem or reflection.
2. They use autocomplete to continue it for six to ten lines.
3. Compare the result with a human-written continuation.
4. Students annotate where the machine is patterned, surprising, empty or meaningful.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Does pattern prediction count as understanding?
- Can creativity exist without intention?
- How does technology change authorship?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...